government should be equally divided between the communists and the so-called London Pols or the London-government-in-exile backed by the British. Lend-lease aid to the Soviet Union was suspended by Washington but Stalin refused to give in and the emergent Polish government remained firmly oriented towards the Soviet Union.

German question proved to be another stumbling block in the superpower relations, which unfolded at the Potsdam Conference of July 1945. The question of post-war reparations from Germany led to sharp arguments. Soviet Union insisted that goods and assets worth 20 billion dollars should be ceased from Germany, of which 50 per cent should be given to the Soviet Union and the rest to be shared between the USA and the UK as war indemnity. But an element of suspicion was harboured by the USA and the UK. The Western powers insisted their right to fix the level of reparations in their own zones of occupation and, by spring 1946, they suspended further reparation payments to the Soviet Union from their zones of occupation in West Germany.[3]

Post-Second World War, Soviet activities in Iran, Turkey and Greece gave birth to suspicions in the West. Initially these factors embittered the relations between the two superpowers, once the allies and gradually assumed the shape of the Cold War. As years passed by the Cold War between the two intensified because of different misconceptions, misperceptions, threats to each other's sphere of influence, increased arms race, and alleged threats to each other's vital interests. Hence, the theatre of Cold War shifted from one part of the world to the other and had unfurled itself in different phases, virtually dividing the world into two antagonistic blocs. The antagonism between the two became evident from the 'long telegram' assessing the sources of Soviet conduct sent by George F.Kennan, the then Diplomat in the American embassy in Moscow. Kennan concluded "In summary, we have here a political force committed fanatically to the belief that with [the] US there can be no permanent *modus operandi*, that, it is desirable and necessary that the internal harmony of our society be disrupted, our traditional way of life be destroyed, the international authority of our state be broken, if Soviet power is to be secured". Thus, what Kennan contended was